

Brookhaven Rail Terminal Expansion Environmental Assessment

Background

Brookhaven Rail Terminal Operations (BRT Operations), the owner of the Brookhaven Rail Terminal (BRT) was looking to expand the 28-acre, aggregate stone, rail-to-truck transfer facility on Long Island, New York. The New York State Fiscal Year 2013-2014 Passenger and Freight Rail Assistant Grant Program, controlled by the New York State Department of Transportation (NYSDOT), had funds available for qualified projects. To apply for funding, BRT needed an environmental assessment (EA) to include with its application. The funds were secured by BRT Operations and construction of the expansion was able to begin.

Scope

Gannett Fleming prepared the EA for the BRT project. The BRT expansion would increase the existing track by approximately 12,500 linear feet, supporting the addition of two warehouse facilities and a lumber/steel bulk-material laydown area, located on an adjacent 95-acre site. The new track would support the possible future expansion of the yard, specifically manufacturing and warehousing operations, and the expanded facility would be expected to handle an estimated 6,300 rail-freight cars annually.

Our firm conducted an air quality emissions analysis, noise analysis, trip generation for regional and local truck trips, and we coordinated with federal and state agencies. A major concern addressed in the EA was the anticipated increase in truck traffic in the area of the BRT expansion. It was determined from the EA results that with sufficient mitigation measures, no long-term or cumulative effects from the project significantly impacted the natural or human environment in the area of the project.

Accomplishments

The EA was completed to support compliance with NEPA, the New York State Environmental Quality Review Act, and other applicable rules



A Brookhaven Rail engine sits on the track at the BRT, located on Long Island, New York.

Client

Brookhaven Rail Terminal Operations, LLC

Location

Brookhaven, New York

Firm's Fee

\$60,000

and regulations. We were heavily involved in, and expertly addressed, agency and stakeholder concerns, including groundwater impacts and effects on local and regional traffic.

The EA was developed under an expedited schedule to meet the New York State Fiscal Year 2013-2014 Passenger and Freight Rail Assistant Grant Program deadlines. All deadlines were met successfully, and the funds for the construction project were secured, based on the findings of the EA.